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Ultrasound apparatus with two-row transfer way of transducer

Abstract

An ultrasonic device employing a two-row moving method of a transducer according to the present disclosure, the ultrasonic device including: a cartridge comprising a transducer configured to generate ultrasonic waves; and a moving device configured to move the transducer, in which the moving device includes: a moving main body; a moving block positioned on the moving main body and connected to the transducer and configured to move with the transducer; a first moving part configured to move the moving block along a first direction; and a second moving part configured to move the moving block along a second direction that intersects the first direction.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates to an ultrasonic device, and more particularly to an ultrasonic device that uses high-intensity focused ultrasound and employs a two-row moving method of a transducer.

BACKGROUND ART

(2) In recent years, a variety of procedures have been developed for skin aesthetics and obesity treatment, and there has been a growing interest in procedures that are performed by non-invasive method.

(3) Ultrasound has been widely used for non-invasive procedures, and ultrasonic devices that utilize high-intensity focused ultrasound (HIFU) have recently become popular. For example, ultrasound devices are being developed to non-invasively perform cosmetic procedures such as face lifting or skin tightening by directing high-intensity focused ultrasonic waves into the skin tissue, or to non-invasively treat obesity by directing high-intensity focused ultrasonic waves into the subcutaneous fat layer to non-invasively burn, melt, and break down fatty tissue.

(4) The high-intensity focused ultrasound device used in procedures for skin aesthetics includes an image monitor, an ultrasound control unit, and a hand piece, the hand piece being coupled to a cartridge containing a transducer that generates ultrasonic waves.

(5) Since the transducer, which generates the ultrasonic waves, reciprocates in a straight line, these ultrasound devices have a narrow treatment range, which makes the treatment slow. The operator has to move the hand piece frequently to increase the treatment range, which makes the treatment to be cumbersome.

DISCLOSURE

Technical Problem

(6) The present disclosure aims to provide an ultrasonic device that is capable of speeding up treatments and minimizing operator's movements.

Technical Solution

(7) An ultrasonic device employing a two-row moving method of a transducer according to the

present disclosure, the ultrasonic device including: a cartridge comprising a transducer configured to generate ultrasonic waves; and a moving device configured to move the transducer, in which the moving device includes: a moving main body; a moving block positioned on the moving main body and connected to the transducer and configured to move with the transducer; a first moving part configured to move the moving block along a first direction; and a second moving part configured to move the moving block along a second direction that intersects the first direction.

(8) The first moving part may include: a moving nut connected to the moving block; a screw part engaged with the moving nut and configured to move the moving block; and a driving motor configured to provide a driving force to the screw part.

(9) The first moving part may further include a pair of guide rods configured to guide the moving block to move along the first direction.

(10) The second moving part may include: a position adjusting part installed on the moving main body and configured to move the moving block along the second direction upon coming into contact with the moving block.

(11) The position adjusting part may include: a lower end position adjusting part coming in contact with a lower end of the moving block; and an upper end position adjusting part coming in contact with an upper end of the moving block.

(12) The second moving part may further include a pair of moving grooves formed in the moving block and allowing the first moving part to move along the second direction.

(13) The guide rod may move to the moving groove when the first moving part moves along the second direction.

(14) The moving block may be installed to be inclined to the first direction.

(15) The cartridge may further include: a cartridge main body having the transducer installed therein; a cartridge block magnetically coupled to the moving block and configured to move with the moving block; and a pair of cartridge guide rods configured to guide the cartridge block to move along the first direction.

(16) The cartridge may further include a cartridge position adjusting part configured to guide the cartridge block to move along the second direction.

(17) The moving device is installed on the moving main body and may further include a motion sensor configured to detect a motion of the moving block.

(18) The cartridge may further include a pressure sensor installed at a lower end of the cartridge and configured to measure pressure applied externally.

Advantageous Effect

(19) The transducer of the ultrasonic device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure may move in the straight section along the first direction, then move along the second direction, and then move along another straight section.

(20) Therefore, the transducer moves along two straight sections and the treatment is performing, thereby allowing for faster and more precise treatments and minimizing the operator's movement because the operator does not need to move the hand piece frequently.

Description

DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of an ultrasonic device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(2) FIG. 2 is a top plan view of a moving device of the ultrasonic device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 3 is a partial front view of the moving apparatus of the ultrasonic device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

- (4) FIG. 4 is a bottom plan view of a cartridge of the ultrasonic device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a front view of the cartridge of the ultrasonic device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (6) FIGS. 6A to 6F are top plan views sequentially illustrating how the moving block of the ultrasonic device moves in two straight sections according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (7) FIG. 7 is a perspective view of an ultrasonic device according to another embodiment of the present disclosure.

MODE FOR INVENTION

- (8) Hereinafter, embodiments of the present disclosure will be described in detail with reference to the accompanying drawings so that those with ordinary skill in the art to which the present disclosure pertains may easily carry out the embodiments. The present disclosure may be implemented in various different ways, and is not limited to the embodiments described herein.
- (9) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of an ultrasonic device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, and FIG. 2 is a top plan view of a moving device of the ultrasonic device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (10) As illustrated in FIGS. 1 and 2, an ultrasonic device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure includes a cartridge **100** including a transducer **120** that irradiates a person to be treated with HIFU, and a hand piece **200** configured to adjust a treatment range in which the person to be treated is irradiated with HIFU.
- (11) The cartridge **100** may include a cartridge main body **110**, a transducer **120** that generates ultrasonic waves, a cartridge block **130**, a pair of cartridge guide rods **140**, and a cartridge position adjusting part **150**.
- (12) The hand piece **200** may include a hand piece main body **210**, and a moving device **220** that is installed within the hand piece main body **210** and moves the transducer **120**.
- (13) The hand piece body **210** has a roughly cuboidal shape, but is not necessarily limited thereto, and various other shapes are possible.
- (14) The moving device **220** may include a moving main body **221**, a moving block **222**, a first moving part **223**, and a second moving part **224**.
- (15) The moving main body **221** may support the moving block **222**, the first moving part **223**, and the second moving part **224**.
- (16) The moving block **222** is positioned on the moving main body **221** and is connected to the transducer **120** so that the moving block **222** may move together with the transducer **120**. A first magnetic member **11** may be installed on an upper portion of the moving block **222**. The moving block **222** may be installed to be inclined to a first direction X in a plan view. Therefore, even when the moving block **222** is in contact with the position adjusting part **31** of the second moving part **224** and moves in a second direction Y, a rotation or position change of the moving block **222** may be minimized.
- (17) The first moving part **223** may allow the moving block **222** to reciprocate along the first direction X.
- (18) The first moving part **223** may include a moving nut **21**, a screw part **22**, a driving motor **23**, and a pair of guide rods **24**.
- (19) The moving nut **21** has a cross-section of a roughly rectangular or parallelogram shape and may be installed inside the moving block **222** to be connected to the moving block **222**. The moving nut **21** has a screw thread formed therein, which may be engaged with the screw part **22**.
- (20) The screw part **22** is engaged with an internal screw thread of the moving nut **21**, so that the moving nut **21** may move forward or backward and reciprocate along the first direction X according to a rotation of the screw part **22**. In this case, the moving block **222** connected to the moving nut **21** may also move with the moving nut.

(21) The driving motor **23** may provide a driving force to the screw part **22** to rotate the screw part **22**, thereby allowing the moving block **222** to move.

(22) FIG. **3** is a partial front view of the moving apparatus of the ultrasonic device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(23) As illustrated in FIG. **3**, the pair of guide rods **24** simultaneously penetrate the moving nut **21** and the moving block **222** and may guide the moving block **222** to move along the first direction X. That is, the pair of guide rods **24** may be positioned in a semicircle-shaped groove formed in the sidewall of the moving nut **21** and in a semicircle-shaped groove adjacent thereto and formed in the sidewall of the moving block **222**. The pair of guide rods **24** may include a first guide rod **241** and a second guide rod **242** positioned on both sides of the screw unit **22**, respectively.

(24) The first moving part **223** may further include a position control unit **60** that controls a position of the moving block **222** that moves in the first direction X. The position control unit **60** may include a position determining portion **61** installed on the moving main body **221** corresponding to the screw unit **22**, and an encoder **62** installed on the driving motor **23**. The position determining portion **61** may include a variable resistor that determines the position of the moving block **222** based on a difference in electrical resistance, or a photo sensor that determines the position of the moving block **222** based on a difference in light intensity.

(25) The second moving part **224** may allow the moving block **222** to move along the second direction Y that intersects the first direction X.

(26) The second moving part **224** may include a position adjusting part **31** and a pair of moving grooves **32**.

(27) As illustrated in FIGS. **1** and **2**, the position adjusting part **31** is installed on the moving main body **221** and may move the moving block **222** along the second direction Y when in contact with the moving block **222**.

(28) The position adjusting part **31** may include a lower end position adjusting part **311** installed on one side of a lower portion of the moving main body **221** and capable of being in contact with the lower end of the moving block **222**, and an upper end position adjusting part **312** installed on the other side of an upper portion of the moving main body **221** and capable of being in contact with the upper end of the moving block **222**.

(29) In this case, as illustrated in FIG. **3**, the pair of moving grooves **32** may include a first moving groove **321** and a second moving groove **322** spaced apart from each other and formed in the moving block **222**. The first moving groove **321** may be formed adjacent to the first guide rod **241**, and the second moving groove **322** may be formed adjacent to the second guide rod **242**. This pair of moving grooves **32** allows the first moving part **223** to move along the second direction Y. For example, when the moving block **222** moves to a right side along the first direction X and comes into contact with the lower end position adjusting part **311**, which is positioned at a lower right side, the second guide rod **242** moves to the second moving groove **322**, so that the moving block **222** may move upward along the second direction Y without much resistance. In addition, when the moving block **222** moves to a left side along the first direction X and comes into contact with the upper end position adjusting part **312**, which is positioned at an upper left side, the first guide rod **241** moves to the first moving groove **321**, so that the moving block **222** may move downward along the second direction Y without much resistance.

(30) FIG. **4** is a bottom plan view of a cartridge of the ultrasonic device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, and FIG. **5** is a front view of the cartridge of the ultrasonic device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(31) As illustrated in FIGS. **1**, **4**, and **5**, the transducer **120** may be installed inside the cartridge main body **110**.

(32) The transducer **120** may irradiate and treat the person to be treated with HIFU.

(33) The cartridge block **130** is magnetically coupled to the moving block **222** and may move with the moving block **222**. In a lower portion of the cartridge block **130**, a second magnetic member **12**

may be installed that is magnetically coupled to the first magnetic member **11** installed in the upper portion of the moving block **222**.

(34) The pair of cartridge guide rods **140** may guide the cartridge block **130** to move along the first direction X. The pair of cartridge guide rods **140** may include a first cartridge guide rod **141** and a second cartridge guide rod **142** positioned on either side with respect to the cartridge block **130**. The pair of cartridge guide rods **140** may penetrate the cartridge position adjusting part **150**.

(35) The cartridge position adjusting part **150** may guide the cartridge block **130** to move along the second direction Y. The cartridge position adjusting part **150** may include a first main member **151** connected to the first cartridge guide rod **141**, a second main member **152** connected to the second cartridge guide rod **142**, and a connection member **153** connecting the first main member **151** and the second main member **152** to each other.

(36) When the moving block **222** moves along the second direction Y, the cartridge block **130** magnetically coupled to the moving block **222** may also move along the second direction Y through the connection member **53**, so that the transducer **120** connected to the cartridge block **130** may move along the second direction Y without much resistance.

(37) FIGS. **6A** to **6F** are top plan views sequentially illustrating how the moving block of the ultrasonic device moves in two straight sections according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(38) As illustrated in FIG. **6A**, the moving block **222** moves to the right side along the first direction **X1** and comes into contact with the lower end position adjusting part **311**, which is positioned at a lower right side, as illustrated in FIG. **6B**. In this case, the transducer **120** that moves with the moving block **222** moves in a straight section to a right side along the first direction **X1**.

(39) Next, as illustrated in FIG. **6C**, the moving block **222**, which is continuously moved by the screw part **22**, is pushed by the lower end position adjusting part **311** to move upward along the second direction **Y1**.

(40) Next, as illustrated in FIG. **6D**, the moving block **222** moves to a left side along the first direction **X2**, and comes into contact with the upper end position adjusting part **312**, which is positioned to an upper left side, as illustrated in FIG. **6E**. In this case, the transducer **120** that moves with the moving block **222** moves to another straight section to a left side along the first direction **X2**.

(41) Next, as illustrated in FIG. **6F**, the moving block **222**, which is continuously moved by the screw part **22**, is pushed by the upper end position adjusting part **312** to move downward along the second direction **Y2**.

(42) As described above, the transducer of the ultrasonic device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure may move in the straight section along the first direction X, then move along the second direction Y, and then move along another straight section. Therefore, since the transducer moves along two straight sections and the treatment is performing, the operator does not need to move the hand piece frequently to move to the next treatment area. Therefore, more evenly spaced and precise treatments are possible.

(43) Meanwhile, other embodiments of the ultrasonic device of the present disclosure are possible in which a motion sensor and a pressure sensor are added.

(44) Hereinafter, with reference to FIG. **7**, an ultrasonic device according to another embodiment of the present disclosure will be described in detail.

(45) FIG. **7** is a perspective view of an ultrasonic device according to another embodiment of the present disclosure.

(46) Another embodiment illustrated in FIG. **7** is substantially the same as an embodiment illustrated in FIGS. **1** to **5**, except for the motion sensor and the pressure sensor, and repetitive descriptions will be omitted.

(47) As illustrated in FIG. **7**, a cartridge of an ultrasonic device according to another embodiment

of the present disclosure may include the cartridge main body **110**, the transducer **120** that generates ultrasonic waves, the cartridge block **130**, the pair of cartridge guide rods **140**, the cartridge position adjusting part **150**, and a pressure sensor **400**.

(48) The pressure sensor **400** may be installed at a lower end of the cartridge **100**, that is, at a lower end of the cartridge main body **110**, to measure externally applied pressure.

(49) Here, the pressure sensor **400** may be positioned at a suitable position on a lower end surface of the cartridge **100** to effectively measure pressure on a skin contact surface when the lower end of the cartridge **100** is in contact with the skin. For example, when the pressure sensor is positioned at each corner of a lower end surface of the cartridge, pressure may be effectively measured as the pressure sensor comes into contact with the skin contact surface.

(50) Ultrasound devices in the related art have a treatment depth of 1 to 5 mm, depending on a position of the transducer inside the cartridge. However, because depth of the treatment may be deeper or shallower, depending on pressure by which an operator presses the cartridge with the hand piece against a treatment area, the depth of the treatment becomes inconsistent since the treatment effectiveness is determined by the operator's skill level.

(51) However, by installing the pressure sensor **400** at the lower end of the cartridge **100**, the ultrasonic device according to the present embodiment may measure the pressure of the hand piece applied to the treatment area and, when the correct pressure is applied, may use light or sound to make the operator recognize the pressure of the hand piece. Therefore, the same treatment effect may be achieved regardless of the operator's skill level.

(52) In addition, the moving device **220** of the ultrasonic device according to another embodiment of the present disclosure may include the moving main body **221**, the moving block **222**, the first moving part **223**, the second moving part **224**, and a motion sensor **500**.

(53) The motion sensor **500** is installed on the moving main body **221** and may detect a motion of the moving block **222**.

(54) In ultrasound devices in the related art, the operator moves the hand piece to navigate the treatment area to apply ultrasound to multiple treatment areas, but the movement to the treatment area cannot be accurately verified, so when the cartridge is not accurately moved to the treatment area, heat may be applied to the same area again, causing necrosis of the skin in the treatment area.

(55) However, by installing the motion sensor **500** on the moving main body **221** of the hand piece **200**, the ultrasound device according to the present embodiment may perform the ultrasound irradiation again when the movement to the treatment area is confirmed after the motion of the moving block **222** is detected. That is, after the treatment position of the moving block **222** is confirmed by the motion sensor **500**, light or sound may be used to help the operator confirm an exact position of the treatment area. Therefore, the operator does not need to identify the position of the ultrasound irradiation each time, and even when the ultrasonic device is operated in continuous mode, heat is not applied to the same treatment area, which can prevent necrosis of the skin in the treatment area.

(56) The motion sensors **500** may include a gyro sensor, an accelerometer, a geomagnetic sensor, or the like.

(57) While the present disclosure has been described with reference to the aforementioned exemplary embodiments, the person skilled in the art will easily understand that the present disclosure is not limited to the disclosed exemplary embodiments, but can be variously corrected and modified without departing from the scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. An ultrasonic device comprising: a cartridge comprising a transducer configured to generate ultrasonic waves; and a moving device configured to move the transducer, wherein the moving device comprises: a moving main body; a moving block positioned on the moving main body and

connected to the transducer and configured to move with the transducer; a first moving part configured to move the moving block along a first direction; and a second moving part configured to move the moving block along a second direction that intersects the first direction, wherein the moving block is installed to be inclined to the first direction in a plane view, the first moving part comprises a moving nut connected to the moving block, and a screw part engaged with the moving nut and configured to move the moving block, and the moving nut is installed on the screw part with a same inclination angle as the moving block.

2. The ultrasonic device of claim 1, wherein: the first moving part further comprises: a driving motor configured to provide a driving force to the screw part.
 3. The ultrasonic device of claim 2, wherein: the first moving part further comprises a pair of guide rods configured to guide the moving block to move along the first direction.
 4. The ultrasonic device of claim 1, wherein: the second moving part comprises: a position adjusting part installed on the moving main body and configured to move the moving block along the second direction upon coming into contact with the moving block.
 5. The ultrasonic device of claim 4, wherein: the position adjusting part comprises: a lower end position adjusting part coming in contact with a lower end of the moving block; and an upper end position adjusting part coming in contact with an upper end of the moving block.
 6. The ultrasonic device of claim 4, wherein: the second moving part further comprises a pair of moving grooves formed in the moving block and the moving block with the moving grooves that allow the moving block to move along the second direction.
 7. The ultrasonic device of claim 1, wherein: the cartridge further comprises: a cartridge main body having the transducer installed therein; a cartridge block magnetically coupled to the moving block and configured to move with the moving block; and a pair of cartridge guide rods configured to guide the cartridge block to move along the first direction.
 8. The ultrasonic device of claim 7, wherein: the cartridge further comprises a cartridge position adjusting part configured to guide the cartridge block to move along the second direction.
 9. The ultrasonic device of claim 1, wherein: the moving device further comprises a motion sensor installed on the moving main body and configured to detect a motion of the moving block.
 10. The ultrasonic device of claim 1, wherein: the cartridge further comprises a pressure sensor installed at a lower end of the cartridge and configured to measure pressure applied externally.
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